Network Influence Maximization Project Management Report

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Which development methodology did you use? How did you manage your time? How did you manage your relationships with key stakeholders (e.g. your supervisor, your external advisor (if you have one), etc.)? How did you manage risk? Were there any unforeseen issues, and if so, how were they handled? Were there any legal, ethical, social or professional issues associated with your project, and how did you handle them?

1 Development Methodology

This is primarily a research project with a large amount of code required, the development is split into two phases.

As described in the timeline in the earlier progress report the software development was focused towards the first half of the project timeline. Scope was known from the research phase, challenges were identified early and goals were set in advance. This is most closely resembling a traditional waterfall development cycle, with periods of lots of development and then acceptance testing (in my case reproducing behaviour exhibited in various research papers) towards the end of the cycle.

The second half of the project is to utilise my code and knowledge around working with networks and the problem space to idenitify a new or novel solution to the network influence maximization problem. This follows more closely to a typical agile development methodology, implementing and quickly testing lots of different ideas to see if they are worthwhile and constantly changing the requirements based on what works so far and what doesn't.

2 Managing my time

Managing time between my other modules, my dissertation and part time work is challenging.

3 Stakeholder Management

No external stakeholders - Just supervisor and myself. - Meetings, progress checks, talk about findings each week etc

4 Risk Management

The main risk being that of not actually finding a novel result or something actually useful. - Documneting all reaseach process - Working through this and with supervisor to find ways that it can be made into something that doesn't yet exist

5 Unforeseen Issues

No real unforeseen issues - talk about challenge of time Management, steering research in the right direction.

6 Legal, Ethical, Social and Professional Issues

As discussed in the specification and project report as this is primarily a research project there are no concerns in this field.